

me in the evening, afore he that was escaped came; and had opened my mouth, until *he* came to me in the morning; and my mouth was opened, and I was no more dumb. Then the word of the LORD came unto me, saying, Son of man, they that inhabit those wastes of the land of Israel speak, saying, Abraham was one, and he inherited the land; but we *are* many; the land is given us for inheritance. Wherefore say unto them, Thus saith the Lord GOD; Ye ²³₂₄

morning the fugitives arrived with the confirmation of all his past predictions.

until he came to me] **should come**: against his coming, Ex. vii. 15.
no more dumb] i.e. silent, Ps. xxxix. 2; Is. liii. 7.

23—29. The confirmation by the fugitives of all his previous predictions gave the prophet boldness to speak anew, and what he says is but a continuation of that which he had said before, and had been so literally confirmed. He had predicted the city's fall because of its sins, and his prophecy had been verified; those remaining in the land continue in the sins for which the city fell, and its fate shall certainly overtake them. The judgment must be carried out till the offences cease. But the teaching of these verses is the natural supplement also to that in vv. 1—20. Those remaining in the land presume that they shall inherit the land because they are in it, notwithstanding their evil conduct: the inheritance of the land will be given on different conditions (vv. 1—20, cf. xxxvi. 25—38, xxxvii. 23).

24. Regarding those remaining in the land even before the fall of the city, cf. xi. 5—12, 14—21; Jer. xxiv. Those remaining in the land express their confident hopes. Though reduced in numbers they are still many in comparison of the single individual Abraham. Yet he was multiplied in such a way as to take possession of the land; much more may they hope yet to assert their claims to it. They perhaps hardly argued on mere natural probabilities; they felt themselves the heirs of the promises made to Abraham, and in spite of disasters hoped that Jehovah would fulfil them to them. They display the same temper as the people had always shewn; they have a faith in Jehovah but no knowledge of what Jehovah is (Am. v. 14; Hos. iv. 1; Jer. iv. 22, v. 2, 4). Another prophet of this age applies the strange history of Abraham and his multiplication to comfort "the few men of Israel" who followed after righteousness, Is. li. 2.

inhabit those wastes] The ruined cities chiefly, v. 27; but cf. xxxvi. 4.

the land is given us] Words of confident anticipation.

25. The claim of the remnant is repudiated by Ezek. with indignation. They persist in the sins for which their country fell, and the same judgment shall overtake them.